moving forward toward a solution based on these lines. It should be reiterated that since the basic proposal of 2002, changes have been made in order to appease Israel.

If this move is taken, Israel will regain the support of the world and recognition of its positive contribution to regional peace and stability. Such peace and stability will free Israel from the burden of the occupation, and it will be able to deal more efficiently and successfully with its internal issues, such as social problems, education, health, and infrastructure. Such an agreement will also yield huge economic dividends for Israel.

Roadmap

As someone who served in the Mossad for thirty-two years, I am a devotee of the secret approach to negotiations. My unequivocal recommendation is that the endeavor to pursue a parallel arrangement must, from its inception and up to a certain point, which I will discuss later, be conducted in secrecy.

The initiative for a regional settlement must begin with a meeting between the Israeli prime minister and the president of the United States, the goal of which would be to agree upon the following:

1. Joint participation in the initiative, which will take place with complete confidentiality up until the point that the partners decide to make it public.
2. The initial participants will be the United States, Israel, the Palestinian Authority, Saudi Arabia, Egypt, Jordan, and the Gulf States. Further down the road, and depending on needs and conditions, other actors can be added (for example, Morocco and Tunisia).
3. Each party—Israel and the United States—will carry out staff work separately and in absolute secrecy, based on the Arab League's 2002 proposal. Israel will summarize its response to the proposal and the changes that have been added to it—its agreements, objections, alternatives, red lines, and open questions. In addition to the permanent status agreement between Israel and the Palestinians, the United States will also address issues related to the desired regional settlement at the interpower and interregional level (this stage can be completed over three intensive months).